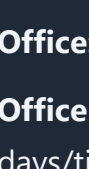




Syllabus- CSN 34: Computer Forensics



Unlock Your Inner I.S. Superpowers!



Meet Your Guide: Professor Information

Professor: Tony Pacheco

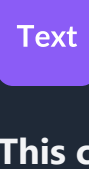
Office: SCMA 137

Office Hours: Mon./Wed. 8:00 to 8:50 am, Tues. 8:15 to 12:15 or other days/time by appointment. Contact via Canvas message Inbox.

Preferred Contact Method: [Use Canvas Inbox](#)

Canvas messaging is best for quick questions! Will respond within 4 to 6 hours. (Generally may respond much quicker.)

Fun Fact: Hey future tech wizards! I'm excited to help you start your C.S. adventure. When I'm not teaching, you can find me on the track, running/training, or online finding some good tech videos or movies!



Course: Information

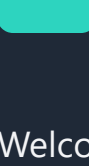
Course: Computer Forensics: 3 Units

Term: Fall 2026, HYBRID: Course In-Person Lab meetings and Online Course work: Section # 72537

Hosted via Canvas at: [sjcd.instructure.com](#)

Final Exam: Online - Week of Dec. 7; Due: 12/9/26

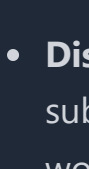
Course Text: (Cengage-Mindtap) Course materials, e-Textbook is to be purchased at Delta bookstore or online through Canvas Cengage link. Required: Guide to Computer Forensics and Investigations; Nelson, et al. 7th ed. 2025; MindTap + eBook; ISBN 9798214028125



Textbook information!

This course uses **Cengage e-textbook**. This includes the Mindtap platform for Cengage Labs. The "e-textbook" is online access with this Mindtap platform available from Delta Bookstore or by accessing the Cengage Link in Canvas.

- **e-Textbook Title:** "Guide to Computer Forensics and Investigations" - 7th ed. 2025
- **Authors:** Nelson, et al
- **Link to Textbook:** Online Purchase access to the Cengage Textbook- [Registration Instructions](#)
- **License Type:** Cengage, vendor.

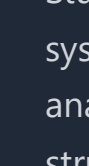


Course Description: Your Mission, Should You Choose to Accept It...

Welcome to "Computer Forensics"! Ever wondered what real-world challenges exist in the connected world? The study of Computer Forensics will open your eyes. Forensics Computing, Digital Forensics, or Computer Forensics is a newly emerging field of study and practice that incorporates many areas of expertise. We will explore network security, intrusion detection, incident response, infrastructure protection, disaster recovery, continuity planning, cybersecurity, and computer crime investigation. Be Cyber Aware!

Official Course Description:

This is an introductory course in Computer Forensics. Forensics Computing, Digital Forensics, or Computer Forensics is the name of a newly emerging field of study and practice that incorporates many areas of expertise. Some of these areas include network security, intrusion detection, incident response, infrastructure protection, disaster recovery, continuity planning, software engineering, cybersecurity, and computer crime investigation. It is an area of practice in public law enforcement at the federal, state, and local levels that deals with cybercrime, cyber vandalism, cyber predators, and cyberterrorism. In the private sector, it involves critical infrastructure, including businesses, hospitals, utilities, transportation, finance, education, and other key institutions). (CSU)



Assignments: the Professor and other Information

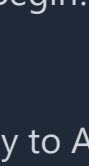
- **Assignments:** Assignments will be listed in weekly course pages and links, as may apply, within the Canvas Modules area.
- **Discussions:** Discussions / posts may also be part of the course assignments. Expectation is to Reply to a Discussion prompt with substantially using a minimum of 120 words and also post a substantive reply to someone else's initial post with at minimum of 80 words.
- **Discussion prompt:** The professor may post an initial prompt reply to start off the Discussion or may use a video for you comment on and discuss. In some instances the Professor may use both a prompt and a video.
- **Evaluation and Grading:** All assignments and tests will carry a point value. Course grade will result from the percentage of total course points that you obtain.
- **Grading Scale:** Grading scale can be seen further down. Assignments overview is also in this syllabus, further down the document with a link to a full Assignments overview/schedule.
- *Always check Canvas Course online for the most current information and assignments or changes.*



Course Objectives

Upon successful completion of this course, the student will be able to:

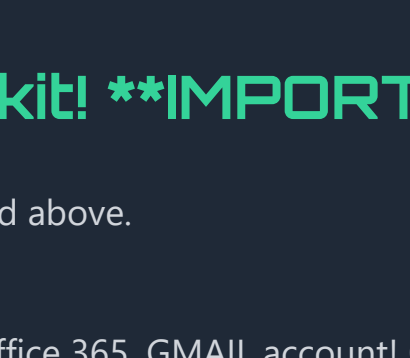
- Students will master industry-standard forensic software tools such as EnCase, FTK, Autopsy, and SANS SIFT, while understanding tool limitations, validation procedures, and when to apply specific tools for different investigative scenarios.
- Students will develop skills in analyzing network traffic, examining mobile devices and cloud storage, investigating internet artifacts, and understanding modern digital communication channels and their forensic implications.
- Students will gain proficiency in examining various file systems (NTFS, FAT, ext4, HFS+), recovering deleted files, analyzing file metadata, and understanding data storage structures across different operating systems.
- Students will learn proper techniques for collecting and preserving digital evidence while maintaining chain of custody protocols and ensuring forensic integrity.
- Students will understand systematic approaches to computer forensic investigations, including case documentation, evidence analysis workflows, and adherence to legal and ethical standards throughout the investigative process.



Learning Outcomes

Upon successful completion of this course, the student will be able to:

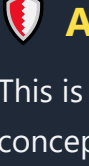
- **** Subject matter knowledge** will be measured by demonstrating fundamental knowledge of Computer Forensics and terminology. ******
- Develop and test hypotheses based on digital evidence analysis.
- Prepare comprehensive forensic reports that clearly communicate technical findings to non-technical audiences.
- Operate professional forensic software suites such as EnCase, FTK, or open-source alternatives like Autopsy.
- Identify and categorize different types of digital evidence found on computers, mobile devices, and network systems.



Key Dates - Mark Your Calendars!

FALL SESSION 2026 DATES. (Download PDF for all Fall sessions/dates)- [Key Dates 2026](#)

- **Start Date (Aug. 14):** First Day of Fall Semester. - Let the Adventure Begin!
- **Drop w/Refund (Aug. 28):** Last day to Drop with Full Refund!
- **Drop w/No'W' (Aug. 28):** Last day to Drop with NO 'W' AND last day to Add.
- **Drop w/'W' (Oct. 13):** Last day to Drop with a 'W'!
- **Finals Week (Dec. 7):** Final Exams Week thru Dec. 11 - The Grand Finale!
- *(Always check Canvas Course dashboard and Online Calendar for other important dates and holidays)*



REQUIRED Text & Items - Your Toolkit! ****IMPORTANT****

- **Textbook (Online, E-Text/platform and Internet Access):** Cengage/Mindtap as noted above.

Note: We'll be using this extensively. You can purchase access to the online textbook at the link provided.

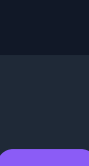
- **Software / Other Online Access:** Netacad.com, TryHackMe.com, LinkedIn Learning, Office 365, GMAIL account! Other software/accounts as noted during the course.

Good news! This software and online apps are free.

- **Hardware: *Important***

- A reliable computer Windows PC - required, with Internet access.
- A USB flash drive for backing up your work (512GB Recommended!)

- **Other:** Access to the college's Learning Management System (LMS) – Canvas! All announcements, assignments, links, and grades will be posted there!



Course Policies & Procedures - The Game Rules!

Attendance & Participation: Your Journey, Your Presence!

Course attendance every week is **IMPORTANT**, ****your presence is crucial****! Lectures, discussions, and activities are designed to help you succeed. Think of it like leveling up in a game – you can't get experience points if you're not playing! Active participation will also count towards your grade. Course assignments, discussions, labs, and tests are how your grade is determined. ****It is your responsibility**** to get all the work done! If you have any questions, PLEASE ASK. I am here to facilitate your success. Check Canvas often, participate, read announcements, and do the assignments. You can do it! ****During the first week of the course there will be 3 check-in assignments due! ** CRUCIAL to avoid being DROPPED!**

"Excessive Absenteeism" Policy!

"Excessive absenteeism" in a course is defined as not participating in the course for an adequate amount of time to successfully pass the course or adequately complete the course. Participation in the course involves completing course activities – simply logging in does not count as participation. If a student does not submit assignments during a time period of 8 consecutive days, 2 or more assignments, OR if a student does not complete a minimum of 65% of assignments by the drop date, the student runs the risk of being dropped from the course for excessive absenteeism. *Pro Tip: Consistency is your most effective tool for success.*

Late Work: Beat the Clock!

Assignments have due dates for a reason – they help you stay on track and build knowledge sequentially. Assignments submitted late will have a penalty. Again, you are responsible for doing the work and doing it on time. Late penalty will be up to 10% of assignment score. (Depending on number of days late). *Pro Tip: Aim to finish early! You'll thank yourself later.*

Make-Up Exams & Emergency Policy: Life Happens!

Make-up exams will only be granted for ****verifiable, documented emergencies**** (e.g., serious illness with a doctor's note, family emergency). You must contact me ****as soon as possible****, preferably before the exam, to discuss arrangements. The same applies to extensions for major assignments under emergency circumstances.

Academic Integrity: Code with Honor!

This is a big one! All work submitted in this course must be ****your own original work****, unless explicitly stated otherwise. ****What's Okay:**** Discussing concepts, getting help understanding errors. ****What's NOT Okay:**** Copying written work or code, sharing completed assignments, having someone else do your work. Any instance of academic dishonesty will result in a ****zero for the assignment/exam****, and may be reported to the college. Let's keep it honest! Tools such as Turnitin may be used to check for similarities.

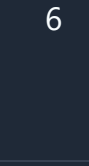
Classroom/Online Conduct, Tutors, and Individual Assistance: Respect is Key!

Our classroom, Online or In Person, is a learning community. Be respectful. Conduct should fit a classroom/learning environment. Be considerate of others. Do not argue, though questioning and presenting of ideas with supportive reasoning is encouraged. In the classroom, silence cell phones. Laptops for notes/exercises only. Ask questions! If you have questions about tutoring, check Delta Online Tutoring/NetTutor at this online link [Tutoring and Academic Support](#) .

You may also consider working with a study group or post a question in the Canvas course discussion board. Post general questions, comments, requests to form study groups, links to interesting articles or websites, or any course related information. Posts that are deemed inappropriate by the professor will be deleted and may result in student discipline. Other students are often quite helpful and will generally provide a lot of support. And, of course, you can always ask the Professor- in an online Canvas message!

Communication: Stay Connected!

Always Check Canvas for announcements. ****Your professor may not have time to respond to all individual communications.** If there are areas of general misunderstanding or errors, the problem may be addressed as an Announcement item or other mass communication method. Please understand that there are over 200 students enrolled in courses taught by your professor, which places a very heavy demand on your professor and as a result there may be little flexibility in handling of individual requests. Canvas email for private communications will be checked on a regular basis and is the best form of direct, private communication with your professor. ****Office hours are best for detailed help!**



Artificial Intelligence, A.I. To use or Not to use? Such is the Question!

This course encourages students to explore the use of AI tools such as ChatGPT for all assessments and assignments. Any use of AI to complete coursework must be appropriately acknowledged and cited. It is each student's responsibility to assess the validity and applicability of any AI output that is submitted. Different classes at Delta have different AI usage policies, and it is the student's responsibility to conform to expectations for each course.



Assistance and Other Important Online Student Information!

Delta maintains a **College Website with Links to important student information including the current [Student Handbook](#)!**

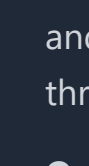
- **Need Assistance?** Students requiring accommodations for a certified disability that may affect class performance are requested to contact me during the first week of the semester. The problem may be addressed as an Announcement item or other mass communication method. Please understand that there are over 200 students enrolled in courses taught by your professor, which places a very heavy demand on your professor and as a result there may be little flexibility in handling of individual requests. Canvas email for private communications will be checked on a regular basis and is the best form of direct, private communication with your professor. ****Office hours are best for detailed help!**
- **Student Services:** Extensive online page with Student services, programs, financial aid information, and other resources for all students! [Student Services](#)
- **CANVAS Access:** To access your classes, course, online resources, L.M.S., and Fully Online courses you need to log into the college online learning tool CANVAS, through your MyDelta Dashboard. For, How to Login to CANVAS?, [Canvas Help](#) .
- **Drops?** "DROPS" ARE THE RESPONSIBILITY OF THE STUDENT. Except for the first 2 weeks of the term, Students may be dropped for non-attendance. The professor reserves the right to make any adjustments in the operation of this course that in professional judgment are warranted to better meet the needs of the students and the objectives of the course.



Access of course materials!

- **Canvas:** All course materials, links, and instructions will be found in your Canvas course app. The Home page will Welcome and introduce you to the course and where to find and access important information, the Textbook, assignments, links to other resource pages or online material.
- **Questions / Guidance?** If you need any assistance at any time, contact me via the Canvas messaging app. This is generally the quickest way to contact me and get a response to your inquiry. Normally you may expect an answer within 2 to 3 hrs, maybe sooner. In some cases, response could be up to 12 hours, but not any longer.
- **Concerns:** During the course if you run across any problem with any of the material, text, videos, assignments, power points, etc., please feel free to provide any feedback on the accessibility or usability of such materials.

Life is ...!



Grading Policy - How You'll Level Up!

Students will be evaluated by a final examination and, at the professor's discretion, one or more of the following: midterms, quizzes, homework, computer programs, discussions, and/or class activities.

Grade Breakdown: (approximate)

- Assignments (Questions, Labs & Problems): 32%
- Quizzes (In-class or Online): 34%
- Midterm Exam: 14%
- Final Exam (Cumulative): 17%
- Participation/other: (3%)

Grading Scale:

- A:** 90-100%
- B:** 80-89%
- C:** 70-79%
- D:** 60-69%
- F:** Below 60%

Level Up Your Skills!

Course Schedule - Your Roadmap to Success!

***CANVAS-** Home page is the first place to start. Find here the most current information, videos, and links, if any. Assignments and weekly page links can also be found in the Modules area of Canvas. An initial overview of assignments is seen below. **Be Advised, Additional Graded Assignments will be added to chapters 9 to 15.** These will be found in the Canvas course Modules area.

Assignments table

Module	Dates	Topic / Module: in CANVAS	Key Activities / Notes
0	Aug. 14 - Aug. 24	Getting Started Module: (+ Cengage Course Orientation); URGENT: Canvas Self-Intro, Syllabus Quiz & Agreement, Cengage/Mindtap- Purchase/registration.	First 3 Days Assignments, various points. Get these done ASAP! (Total points, 25), Cengage (Orientation 65 points).
1	Aug. 24 - Aug. 29	Module 1: Understanding the Digital Forensics Profession and Investigations. Read Chpt. + 4 assignments/projects.	Cengage/Homework assignments & Quiz (Total points, 60).
2	Aug. 29 - Sept. 05	Module 2: Report Writing and Testimony for Digital Investigations. Read Chpt. + 4 assignments/projects.	Cengage/Homework assignments and chapter Quiz. (Total points, 40).
3	Sept. 05 - Sept. 12	Module 3: The Investigator's Laboratory and Digital Forensics Tools. Read Chpt. + 5 assignments/prjcts.	Cengage/Homework assignments & Quiz . (Total points, 40).
4	Sept. 12 - Sept. 19	Module 4: Data Acquisition. Read Chpt. + 4 assignments/projects.	Cengage/Homework assignments & Quiz . (Total points, 45).
5	Sept. 19 - Sept. 26	Module 5: Processing Crime and Incident Scenes. Read Chpt. + 4 assignments/projects.	Cengage/Homework assignments & Quiz . (Total points, 45).
6	Sept. 26 - Oct. 03	Module 6: Working with Microsoft File Systems and the Windows Registry. Read Chpt. + 4 assignments/projects.	Cengage/Homework assignments & Quiz . (Total points, 45).
7	Oct. 3 - Oct. 10	Module 7: Linux and Macintosh File Systems. Read Chpt. + 4 assignments/projects.	Cengage/Homework assignments & Quiz . (Total points, 50).
**	Oct. 12	Midterm Exam: DUE Oct. 17	Midterm Exam- Covers Chapters. 1-7, 1 attempt, Timed 94 min., (110 points)
8	Oct. 12 - Oct. 17	Module 8: Media Files and Digital Forensics. Read Chpt. + 3 assignments/projects.	Cengage/Homework assignments & Quiz . (Total points, 50).
9	Oct. 17 - Oct. 24	Module 9: Virtual Machine Forensics and Live Acquisitions Forensics. Read Chpt. + 3 assignments/projects.	Cengage/Homework assignments & Quiz . (Total points, 20).
10	Oct. 24 - Oct. 31	Module 10: Network Forensics. Read Chpt. + 3 assignments/projects.	Cengage/Homework assignments & Quiz . (Total points, 20).
11	Oct. 31 - Nov. 07	Module 11: Cloud Forensics and the Internet of Anything. Read Chpt. + 3 assignments/projects.	Cengage/Homework assignments & Quiz . (Total points, 20).
12	Nov. 07 - Nov. 14	Module 12: Mobile Device Forensics. Read Chpt. + 4 assignments/projects.	Cengage/Homework assignments, Quiz, & project. (Total points, 20).
13	Nov. 14 - Nov. 21	Module 13: Email and Social Media Investigations. Read Chpt. + 2 assignments/projects.	Cengage/Homework assignments, Quiz, & project. (Total points, 20).
14	Nov. 21 - Nov. 30	Module 14: e-Discovery. Read Chpt. + 2 assignments/projects.	Cengage/Homework assignments, Quiz, & project. (Total points, 20).
15	Nov. 30 - Dec. 06	Module 15: Ethics and Professional Responsibilities. Read Chpt. + 3 assignments/projects.	Cengage/Homework assignments, Quiz, & project. (Total points, 20).
16	Dec. 06 - Dec. 07	Module 16: End of Course items. Course survey, Exam information, and Final exam review.	Cengage/Homework assignments, Survey. (Total points, 2).
Finals	DEC. 07 - 09	Final Exam - DUE Dec. 09	Good Luck! You Got This! (Total points, 160).

Assignments - Additional information!

- **Projects:** Such as Essays, PowerPoint Presentations, and other major assignments: exercises to work through during the course may be assigned and seen in Canvas. These exercises are to increase your ability to recognize how Forensics systems are best used and their purpose in business environments. Expect to spend some time reading through related chapters and then working through the exercises.
- **Quizzes:** Will cover Chapter material for each Module and chapter readings. Keep those neurons firing!
- **Midterm & Final Exams:** Will assess your understanding of concepts and your ability to apply them. They will include multiple-choice, short answer, and some T/F questions.
- **(Yet to be determined) Final Project:** [A Project will be announced prior to the Midterm. "A culminating project" More details will be provided separately.]

DATA is VALUED!

A Final Byte of Wisdom...

Learning computer science is like learning a new language and a new way of thinking. It takes practice, persistence, and patience. Don't be afraid to make mistakes – they are part of the learning process! Ask for help when you need it, collaborate (appropriately!), and most importantly, have fun exploring what you can create! I'm here to help you succeed. Let's have an amazing semester!